AC · every 3 weeks

Doxorubicin and cyclophosphamide on Day 1 every 21 days for four cycles. Any subsequent taxane follows a separately agreed regimen.

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient review pending. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

1 Heart

Doxorubicin

Baseline assessment; report chest pain, breathlessness or swelling.

2 Blood / infection

Chemotherapy phase

Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: call immediately.

3 Hair / scalp

Chemotherapy phase

Hair loss is common. Ask about scalp cooling before treatment where suitable.

4 Mouth

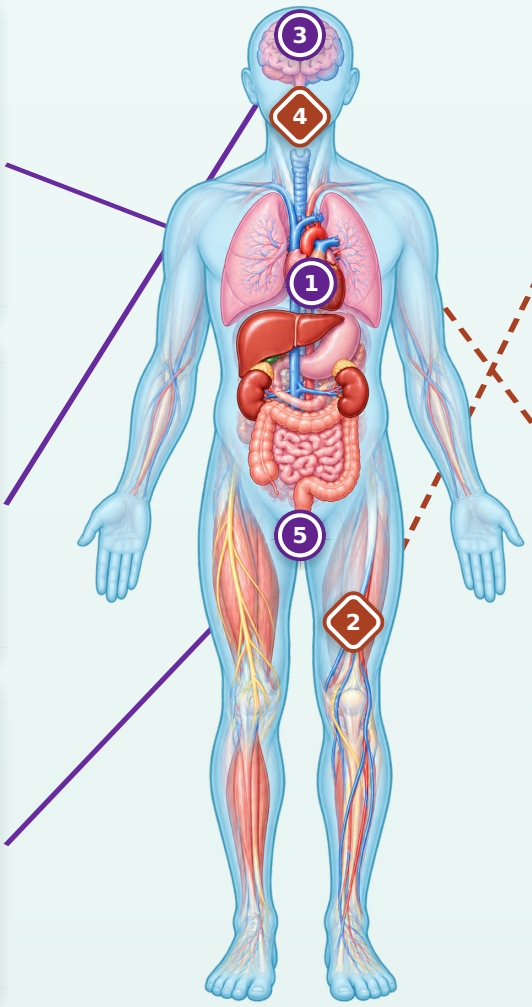
Chemotherapy phase

Painful ulcers or difficulty drinking need advice.

5 Bladder

Cyclophosphamide

Report blood in urine or painful urination.



Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Selected medicine-specific effects; the full risk discussion includes hair loss, fertility and other individual risks.

> Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: contact oncology immediately. Severe chest pain, breathing difficulty, collapse or seizure: 112 / 999.

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Doxorubicin

- Low counts, infection and mouth ulcers
- Nausea, hair loss and fatigue
- Heart damage, sometimes delayed
- Severe tissue injury if the infusion leaks
- Rare later blood cancers

Cyclophosphamide

- Low counts and infection
- Nausea, vomiting and hair loss
- Bladder irritation / bleeding
- Fertility effects and menopause
- Rare later blood cancers

Surgery, radiation and monitoring: open the whole-treatment map or scan the QR.

Make the plan practical

The correct phase prescription

AC uses the high-risk antiemetic plan.

Premedicines and growth factors

Confirm antiemetic and growth-factor prescriptions before leaving the unit.

Tests and appointments

The team should name the booking owner, due window and person reviewing each required test. Tell them if an expected appointment has not arrived.

After chemotherapy

Discuss recovery, fertility, rehabilitation and the next treatment or surveillance step.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

CUH · MON–FRI 8AM–5PM

087 181 9645

Acute Oncology Service

CUH · WEEKENDS / BANK HOLIDAYS 9AM–5PM

021 4922000

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00252/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.